Q+A

Wonder WOMAN

***Huma S. Qureshi** turns writer with **Zeba: An Accidental Superhero**, her foray into the realm of fantasy fiction*



ZEBA: AN ACCIDENTAL SUPERHERO
By Huma S. Qureshi
HARPERCOLLINS
₹499; 208 pages

Q. How long has the book been brewing?

I have always been fascinated by the superhero narrative and fantasy fiction. Initially, I wrote *Zeba* as a screenplay for a series. However, I realised that making a superhero film set in a fantasy world would require a big budget. During Covid, I revisited the screenplay and decided to turn it into a book.

Q. What is the story about?

Zeba: An Accidental Superhero is a tale that combines magic, wonder, and passion. It's a story of heroism and the indomitable human spirit in the face of adversity. The protagonist is relatable yet unique and a symbol of resilience. She is also a misfit but eventually figures out how to navigate the world.

Q. Why did you choose the fantasy genre?

Fantasy is a genre I have always been drawn to. Deadpool is my kind of superhero. Marjane Satrapi's graphic memoir *Persepolis* also captured my imagination. Growing up, Gabriel García Márquez and his magic realism impacted me a lot. I guess, *Zeba* was born out of all of this.

Q. How much of Huma Qureshi is in the book and can we expect more from her pen soon?

Every character in the book has a little bit of me and the people that I have observed and interacted with over the years. But it's a work of fiction, not autobiographical at all. As for more books, yes, but then again I am waiting to see how many copies this one sells! (*laughs*)

with Amit Dixit

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